SEUNG-WA AKPAN

Applied AI & Backend Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Applied AI engineer building production speech and LLM systems in Python. Main engineer on OraScribe (orascribe.ai), a transcription and translation platform: GPU model serving on Modal, Celery job pipelines, billing, and the evals that test them. Checks changes with regression tests and measurements on real workloads.

CORE SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

AI & LLM: LLM evals, vLLM, Modal serverless GPUs, Whisper, Silero VAD, Qwen3, OpenAI, Gemini, RAG, embeddings, LangChain

Backend: Python, Flask, FastAPI, Celery, Node.js, TypeScript, NestJS, Express.js, REST APIs, webhooks, WebSockets, JWT, OAuth 2.0

Data & Infrastructure: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, ChromaDB, BullMQ, Docker, AWS, Linux, CI/CD, Sentry, S3 / MinIO

Testing & Tooling: pytest, Jest, OpenAPI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Python Developer · *Kevin Winter Foundation* | Remote | January 2025 – Present

- Build and maintain OraScribe's AI pipeline for transcription, translation and summaries on Flask, Celery, Redis and Modal serverless GPUs, using Whisper for speech-to-text and vLLM for LLM serving.
- Cut LLM cold-start time on staging from 266s to 13–30s in most runs by restoring a saved GPU memory snapshot.
- Tested Qwen3-4B against the M2M100 translation model on 15 idioms before building an LLM translation path behind a flag: word-for-word mistranslations fell from 11 to at most 1, and a 122-segment job went from 86s to 21s.
- Found the voice activity filter was silently dropping sung speech; after the fix, one 8-minute recording went from 120 to 421 transcribed words. Added a loudness-based check so similar losses show up in metrics.
- Built an eval suite that checks transcripts for dropped speech: fast no-GPU tests on every commit, plus a 5-minute real-GPU run that fails on the old settings that lost speech and passes on production.
- Directed coding agents through an audit of 29 Celery tasks that found six defects, five of them affecting money or data, mostly retried tasks that could apply their effect twice. Every fix ships with a test that fails on the old code.
- Moved 30–100+ minute GPU jobs off a single long-held connection, which dropped and lost jobs on deploys, to a submit, poll and reconcile flow behind a rollback flag.

Backend Developer · *KSolutions* | Nigeria | Part-time | February 2025 – March 2026

National Youth Service Corps: Nigeria's mandatory one-year graduate service placement

- Developed the backend for a people-matching application using Node.js, Express, and SQL, covering appointment scheduling and match status management.
- Built user matching with compatibility scoring, plus an admin API for match coordinators.

Backend Engineering Intern · *HNG Tech* | Remote | Part-time | October 2025 – December 2025

Open-enrolment engineering fellowship; reached finalist stage

- Built APIs with Node.js, TypeScript and NestJS for an AI chat platform.
- Integrated Google Gemini for chat replies that use stored history in MongoDB.
- Added real-time messaging over Socket.IO, Redis-based rate limiting and S3-compatible (MinIO) file uploads.

Backend Developer Intern · *Resourceful Dev* | Abuja, Nigeria | July 2023 – September 2023

- Built a Blog API in Node.js and Express with JWT auth, role-based access, Redis caching and Jest tests.

SELECTED PROJECTS

HP Community | *Astro · Progressive Web App · Cloudflare*
hpcommunity.app · read.hpcommunity.app

- Built and run two live progressive web apps for a faith community: a companion app (about 25 weekly active users over three months, peaking at 38, tracked in PostHog) and a reading library.
- The library serves 7,400+ paragraphs across two books with full-text search and annotation, plus reading plans whose daily target recalculates from each reader's actual progress.

Document RAG Service | *NestJS · TypeScript · ChromaDB · LangChain · OpenRouter · Docker*
github.com/seung-waedet/document-rag-service

- Retrieval-augmented generation API that ingests PDF, DOCX, and TXT files, chunks and embeds them into ChromaDB, and answers natural-language questions with an LLM.
- Chunks with LangChain's RecursiveCharacterTextSplitter and calls Llama 3 through OpenRouter, so the model provider can change; ChromaDB runs in Docker Compose.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.Sc. Computer Science, First Class Honours (CGPA 4.73 / 5.00), Arthur Jarvis University, Nigeria | 2021 – 2024

Diploma in Backend Engineering, AltSchool Africa | 2023 – 2024

LEADERSHIP

Google Developer Student Club, Founding Lead · *Arthur Jarvis University* | August 2022 – August 2023

- Founded and led the university's first GDSC chapter, organising 12+ technical workshops on web development, APIs, and cloud technologies.